

A change of scenery

It was hardly an accident that Leonardo ended up in Milan in 1482. He traveled to Milan at the invitation of the Sforza family.

At the time, Milan was threatened by the Papal States, which were ruled by the pope, and by Venice to the east. The Sforza family, headed by Ludovico Sforza, controlled Milan, and it needed soldiers, engineers, and other men with military experience.

Leonardo had presented himself to Ludovico as a military engineer, which was stretching the truth considering his lack of experience in battle. However, he did know a few things about the subject.



Ludovico Sforza